

Territory Pitch

Territory Title

AI for Making Comics

One-Sentence Curiosity Statement

I want to explore how AI can help make comics without taking over the creator's style, choices, or story.

Short Paragraph

This matters because comics need both good visuals and good storytelling, and AI does not always keep those things consistent. I am interested in how AI can speed up parts of the process, but also where it starts to mess things up or make the work feel less personal. The main tension is figuring out when AI is actually helpful and when it gets in the way. This could lead into a workflow, guide, or test system for using AI while still keeping the creator in control.

Three Possible Directions

1. Comic-Making Workflow Guide

A simple guide showing where AI helps in the comic process, like brainstorming, character ideas, panel planning, and visual references.

2. Character and Style Consistency Test

A project testing how well AI can keep the same character, setting, and visual style across multiple comic panels.

3. Prompt-to-Panel Experiment

A test where I give AI a comic idea and see how well it turns that into panels, dialogue, mood, and visual direction.

One AI Evidence Item

Prompt experiment:

Use the same comic prompt in different AI models and compare what each one does better or worse.

Example prompt:

"Create a 6-panel webcomic idea about a sci-fi horror character finding something alive inside an abandoned spaceship. Include panel descriptions, dialogue, mood, and visual style notes."

Three Feedback Questions

1. Does this feel focused enough, or is it still too broad?

2. Would this work better as a workflow guide, a consistency test, or a small webcomic prototype?

3. What part should I focus on most: story, visuals, consistency, or the whole comic-making process?

ChatGPT

https://chatgpt.com/share/69f2587d-87f...

See what this chat's about

ChatGPT is your AI chatbot for everyday use. Chat with the most advanced AI to explore ideas, solve problems, and learn faster.

EM Emanuel 2 weeks ago

In my opinion, it's pretty focused. I like how specialized your territory is. Since you mentioned that you want to explore how AI can help make comics without taking over the creator's voice, I think you should go with the Comic-making workflow guide. I feel like this direction will give you the most insight since the creative-process is where the story is made. It may be more work, but I would love to see the whole comic-making process with AI's help, visuals and all.

Reply

Prompt 1: Single Shot Exploration

ChatGPT

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Prompt 2: Structured project direction

ChatGPT

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Prompt 3: Multishot Prompt

ChatGPT

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See what this chat's about

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Links

Character Reference

https://leonardo.ai/learn/core-feature/ho...

How to Create Consistent Characters with Character Reference | Leonardo AI

Creating consistent AI-generated character designs is essential for projects like comic book series or concept art, but it can be challenging, especially with illustrative styles. To simplify the process, we've created this tutorial to help you craft uniform, cohesive characters with ease.

https://arxiv.org/html/2409.17263v1?utm...

Collaborative Comic Generation: Integrating Visual Narrative Theories with AI Models for Enhanced Creativity

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https://www.nilahmagruder.com/blog/20...

Character Design and Consistency

A quick guide to maintaining consistency in character design for sequential illustration.

1. Project Identity Card

Project Title

Panel Forge: Building Comics with AI

Curiosity Statement

How can AI help create comic and webcomic visuals without destroying consistency, style, and human authorship?

Short Summary

This project explores how AI can support the process of making comics and webcomics. I am interested in where AI helps most: brainstorming, character design, panel layouts, visual references, writing, or production drafts. The main tension is whether AI can speed up comic creation while still keeping the work visually consistent and personally directed. This could lead to a guide, workflow system, or prototype for artists/designers using AI in sequential storytelling.

Audience / Context

Design students, comic creators, webcomic artists, illustrators, and beginners trying to use AI without losing control of their visual style.

Possible Final Directions

DirectionWhat it could becomeAI Comic Workflow GuideA website showing the best AI workflow from idea to comic pageCharacter Consistency ToolkitA system for keeping characters visually consistent across panelsWebcomic PrototypeA short AI-assisted webcomic showing process documentationPrompt LibraryA set of tested prompts for characters, panels, scenes, and revisions

2. Inquiry Brief

Research Question

How can AI tools be used to support comic and webcomic creation while maintaining visual consistency, clear storytelling, and human creative control?

Why It Matters

Comics rely on consistency. Characters, style, layout, emotion, and pacing all have to work across multiple panels. AI can generate images quickly, but it often struggles with keeping the same character, proportions, costume, and tone across a sequence. That makes comics a good test case for whether AI is actually useful in a real design workflow or just good at making one-off images.

What I Need to Learn

Need to LearnWhyHow AI handles character consistencyComics need repeated characters across panelsHow prompt structure affects visual resultsBetter prompts may reduce random outputsWhich tools are better for writing, visuals, layouts, or refinementNot every model should do the same jobHow much human direction is neededThe goal is workflow support, not full automationHow AI changes the comic-making processThis connects directly to design practice

2-3 Possible Final Outcomes

1. A comic creation workflow website

A guide that breaks down which AI tools work best at each stage.

2. A visual prompt system for comics

A prompt library organized by character, scene, panel, action, mood, and revision.

3. A short webcomic case study

A small comic prototype showing the AI-assisted process from rough idea to final panels.

3. Source Starter List

You only need 2-3 starting sources right now, but the assignment says you will eventually need at least 8.

Source 1

Title: Character Design and Consistency

Creator: Nilah Magruder

Link: Use source page in your board

Type: Artist blog / process article

Why it might matter:

This is useful because it talks about maintaining character consistency through shape language, proportions, and big visual decisions. That gives you a non-AI foundation to compare against AI workflows. (Nilah Magruder)

Source 2

Title: Creating Consistent Characters with Character Reference

Creator: Leonardo AI

Type: AI tool tutorial

Why it might matter:

This source directly connects to the biggest comic-making problem with AI: keeping the same character across different images and scenes. It can help you test whether reference-based workflows solve character drift. (Leonardo AI)

Source 3

Title: Integrating Visual Narrative Theories with AI Models for Comics Creation

Creator: arXiv research paper

Type: Academic / research paper

Why it might matter:

This gives your project more research weight because it connects AI to visual sequences, storytelling, and comics as a creative system, not just single-image generation. (arXiv)

4. Project Brief / Weekly Roadmap

Week 5 — Set the Foundation

CategoryPlanGoalBuild the Command Center and clarify the project directionActivitiesCreate project identity card, inquiry brief, source list, and workspace structureToolsMilanote, Notion, Figma, ChatGPTOutputOrganized project boardSuccess IndicatorSomeone can open the board and understand the project immediately

Week 6 — Research AI + Comics

CategoryPlanGoalUnderstand what problems AI creates or solves in comic productionActivitiesCollect sources about AI image generation, character consistency, comic layouts, webcomics, and authorshipToolsGoogle Scholar, YouTube, articles, ChatGPT, PerplexityOutput8-source research list with notesSuccess IndicatorResearch clearly shows the main problem: consistency vs speed

Week 7 — Test Prompts and Tools

CategoryPlanGoalRun small AI experiments for comic creationActivitiesTest character prompts, scene prompts, panel prompts, and style promptsToolsChatGPT, Midjourney, DALL-E, Leonardo, Firefly, FigmaOutputPrompt log and experiment screenshotsSuccess IndicatorYou can identify which prompts worked, failed, and why

Week 8 — Build Workflow System

CategoryPlanGoalTurn research and experiments into a usable workflowActivitiesMap the comic process from idea → script → character → panels → refinementToolsFigma, Milanote, ChatGPTOutputWorkflow diagramSuccess IndicatorThe workflow shows where AI helps and where the human designer takes control

Week 9 — Prototype Final Direction

CategoryPlanGoalStart making the final thingActivitiesChoose between guide, toolkit, prompt library, or webcomic case studyToolsFigma, Figma Make, AI image toolsOutputFirst prototypeSuccess IndicatorThe project has a visible form, not just notes

Week 10 — Refine and Document

CategoryPlanGoalImprove the prototype and organize process documentationActivitiesAdd research evidence, prompt logs, failures, revisions, and takeawaysToolsFigma, website builder, ChatGPTOutputRefined prototype / website draftSuccess IndicatorThe process is clear and the project argument makes sense

Week 11 — Finalize

CategoryPlanGoalComplete final presentation and submit projectActivitiesPolish visuals, tighten writing, organize final links, prepare critique questionsToolsFigma, final site, Milanote/NotionOutputFinal project and documentationSuccess IndicatorThe final project shows what you investigated, what you learned, and what you made

5. Prompt Log

Set up this section now, even if you only have 1-2 entries.

Prompt Log Template

EntryPrompt UsedModel / ToolOutput SummaryWhat Changed

Afterward1"Generate 5 possible AI + Design project directions focused on comic books and webcomics."ChatGPTGave possible directions like workflow guide, webcomic prototype, and character consistency toolkitHelped narrow the project toward AI-assisted comic creation2"Create a prompt for generating a consistent comic character across multiple panels."Image AI / ChatGPTProduced a character prompt with style, costume, pose, and expression detailsWill test whether repeated visual traits improve consistency

6. Experiment Log

Experiment 1 — Character Consistency Test

CategoryNotesWhat you triedGenerate the same comic character in 3 poses or scenesScreenshots / NotesAdd outputs side by sideWhat workedMaybe costume, color palette, silhouetteWhat failedFace changed, proportions shifted, style driftedNext stepBuild a stronger character sheet prompt

Experiment 2 — Panel Layout Test

CategoryNotesWhat you triedGenerate a 3-panel comic sequence from one short sceneScreenshots / NotesAdd prompt + outputWhat workedMood, setting, actionWhat failedPanel order, speech bubble placement, character consistencyNext stepSeparate writing, layout, and image generation into different workflow steps

7. Links / Workspace

Create a final section called **Workspace Links**.

Link TypeWhat to AddBoardMilanote / Notion / Figma Command Center linkSourcesArticles, videos, academic papers, tutorialsAI Tools UsedChatGPT, Midjourney, DALL-E, Leonardo, Firefly, etc.Working FilesFigma files, generated images, screenshotsFinal Site / RepoAdd later if relevant